

Incident Response Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy establishes procedures for responding to cybersecurity incidents to minimize damage, reduce recovery time, and protect sensitive data.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all systems, networks, and data within the organization including customer data, financial records, and internal communications.

3. Incident Classification

Level	Type	Example
Tier 1	High	Data breach, ransomware, legal escalation
Tier 2	Medium	Phishing attempt, unauthorized access attempt
Tier 3	Low	Spam emails, minor policy violations

4. Response Steps

1. **Identify** — Detect and confirm the incident
 2. **Contain** — Stop the incident from spreading
 3. **Eradicate** — Remove the threat completely
 4. **Recover** — Restore systems back to normal
 5. **Report** — Document everything that happened
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5. Who Handles What

- **Tier 1** — Legal + Management notified immediately
 - **Tier 2** — Senior Analyst investigates
 - **Tier 3** — Junior Analyst reviews and monitors
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6. Author Note

This policy was created based on NIST SP 800-61r2 guidelines and informed by hands-on experience triaging Tier 1 through Tier 3 complaints and escalations at a high-volume fintech company.

7. Incident Triage Process

Based on real-world fintech incident response experience

When an incident is detected the analyst will:

Step 1 — Grab and Review the Case Analyst reviews the incoming case and reads the language used to determine severity level.

Step 2 — Classify the Incident

- Tier 1 — Legal team is immediately involved
- Tier 2 — Escalation team is notified to investigate and determine fault
- Tier 3 — Minor issue, analyst handles independently

Step 3 — Investigate Analyst cross-references the following:

- IP address origin — does it match the client's known devices?
- Account activity — are there mismatches in login behavior?
- Client history — is this a repeat incident?

Step 4 — Document Everything All findings are logged in the case management system with timestamps, findings and resolution.

